

Bose QuietComfort 2 Acoustic Noise Cancellation Headphones

Thumping Sound, No Noise

The Bose Noise Cancellation 2 is surprisingly low-impedance. You don't need a headphone amplifier for great sound. Plug it to a portable player, your computer's sound card, or any other device. You can select the input level on the phones accordingly.

The sound is good and lively. However, without an equaliser, the bass refuses to thump, and the highs aren't vivid. The mid-frequencies are emphasised, which is not a bad thing if you are primarily listening to vocal tracks. But it really hurts if you want to use the phones, for say, classical music.

These are closed-ear phones—you don't get the open 'speakers' kind of sound that you get with high-end Sennheisers.

The set has a noise-cancellation feature, and that's where you are spending your money on. We don't know if it was the noise-cancellation or the excellent earpads, but we couldn't hear a squeak from elsewhere once the phones were on. Good stuff!

There's no limit to the volume these phones can take the highs and lows to without distortion. One glitch though, when the phones get too much bass, the volume goes down. The volume shoots up again when the bass goes down.

The bottomline? These are not audiophile-quality phones, and you will be better off investing on high-end Grados or Sennheisers. Or in-ear noise-reducing phones such as those from Etymotic, if you are hell-bent on noise-cancellation.



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Samsung Yepp Sports YP-60

Time for Healthy Music

All gadgets are headed for convergence. It's only natural to marry two more devices of utmost importance while working out. A portable music player and a calorie/heart rate monitor. The Samsung Yepp Sports YP-60 is a featherweight 256 MB MP3/WMA/FM player that records music or radio to MP3s, and can strap onto your arm. The bundled, and not-quite-easy-to-use Yepp Studio application lets you transfer music from your computer on to the player via a USB cable. The calorie/heart rate monitor and stopwatch, together with the Fitness Studio software, helps you burn calories the right way. At Rs 15,995 though, it's more likely to burn a hole in your pocket!



Company Samsung Electronics
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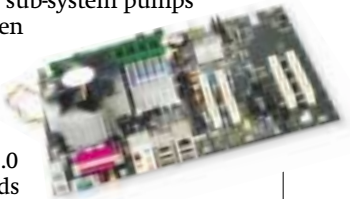
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Intel D925 XCV Motherboard

This LGA775 socket motherboard, based on the i925X chipset, supports the latest generation of Pentium 4 processor.

It support for DDR2 533 MHz memory and PCI Express X16 graphics slot. An onboard high-definition audio sub-system pumps out quality music when hooked up to a seven-speaker system.

Gigabit Ethernet, two PCI Express X1 slots, and eight USB 2.0 ports offer great speeds and expandability.



Company Intel
Web site www.intel.com

Intel Prescott 3.6GHz Processor

Clocked at 3.6GHz, Intel's new chip is based on the LGA 775 platform. It is meant for the 915 and 925 chipset-based motherboards that will hit the market by this December.

Installing the processor is as simple as it was with the Socket 478 ones. With the pins now transferred to the motherboard, the motherboard socket surely needs better care and handling.

We plugged the processor onto Intel's D925XCV motherboard with 533 MHz DDR2 memory and a FX5300 PCI-E card. But, the higher the clock speed, the more is the heat.

When it came to performance, it cruised in most of our tests. The performance boost ranged from six to 10 per cent.



Company Intel
Web site www.intel.com

Gigabyte GV NX53128D Graphics Card

It is the first PCI-Express X16 graphics card we tested. Based on nVidia's FX-5300 graphic core, it is not very powerful. DirectX 9 compliance gives gamers a decent resolution.

After tucking the Gigabyte in the X16 slot of the Intel D925XCV motherboard, supported by the 3.6GHz processor, we ran our usual tests. The card performed quite well, and surely falls in the same league of cards based on the FX-5200.

We ran DOOM 3 on it—the acid test. It runs DOOM 3 at an 800 x 600 resolution and medium details—good choice for casual gamers.



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